

Q8. (a) Culture is unique to human beings. Do you agree? Present arguments in favour and against the statement. (15 marks)

Culture is defined by MALINOWSKI having material and non-material aspect. Malinowski calls culture as social heritage and way of life.

Culture is unique to human beings

- This idea is subscribed by Culture - Personality school.
- Anthropologists like Margaret Mead believed that culture is unique to human.
- However they believed that studying culture in other organisms is futile.

Arguments in favour

- The quality and quantity of cultural trait present in human is far superior.
- The complexity of human culture.
- The invention of language is unique.
- The capacity of human being to

others can vocalise but no language

give meanings to symbol. is unique.

For eg.: For example meanings attached to colors.

- Rituals and ceremonies having implicit meanings is unique (Ex) cock fight in Balinese culture.

Thus all the above points that culture is unique to human being.

However, many other school of thought points out that culture exist in other organisms

Arguments

- Many species of birds especially songbirds have learned behaviours
- Honey-bees have communication mechanism.
- Yorillas make use of primitive tools

However culture present in above organism is not that evolved.

They lack

↳ Culture transmission

↳ Culture complexes

↳ Culture configurations

Thus it could be said that culture is unique to human.

Learned Behaviour

→ Japanese Macaque

→ Tool by chimpanzee.

language → Koko - deaf language

tought to other Leah

study by Jane Goodall

→ Core, culture, spiritualism, materialism, dance.

Humans have created definition of culture in which only Human can fit in.